Statement

Sensitive

Statement in the matter of R v Vida REID

Name	Rhiannon TEAGUE
Occupation	Beauty Therapist
Address	Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS)
Date	11 October 2022

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

2. My full name is Rhiannon TEAGUE.

3. My residential address is known to the National Disability Insurance Scheme.

4. I am the mother of Max TEAGUE who is a participant with NDIS and has been since 2021.

5. Max's NDIS number is 431754820.

6. Max has a diagnosis of Autism Spectrum Disorder, This impacts on his social skills and communication. His behaviour is affected in that he is very routine based, and introverted. When he is overstimulated, he can become aggressive. Max can be very literal, and this can cause conflicts with others

7. Max has issues going out into the community and interacting with others, Social Cues are also hard for him to interpret.

8. I sought NDIS funding so that Max could engage with providers for behaviour supports and an Occupational therapist.

RTeague

Signature

Witness

9. The OT is working on improving his daily activities and daily living skills.

10. The Behaviour specialist is working with Max in learning how to interact with others and to manage his emotions.

11. When Max's plan was approved I was advised to google plan managers, I think that the local area coordination gave me a list of three possible mangers and I chose from that list. I chose Provider choice to work with us.

12. When I contacted the plan managers and we discussed providers for Behaviour therapists and OT's, Not long after I received an email from Hey Hubble who said they could help me to find providers. Forward Focused Group. (FFG) was one of the providers recommended for behaviour therapies, but when I looked on their web site they did not do Behaviour Therapies. Harry BOURKE from Hey Hubble assured me that they did and someone from FFG would contact me soon. They also recommended an OT but that did not work out due to Max not connecting with her. We have since found a new person to work with Max.

    Exhibit : I now produce email dated 18th September , 2021 from Hey Hubble in relation to the referral to FFG. Annexure RT 01

13. On the 24/09/21 Luke Hazelwood from FFG called to explain what his Behavioural therapy was and how it could help Max. On this call I decided that it sounded like he could help and we agreed to an initial meeting. He told me that in order for him to do this meeting he would need me to send Max's plan through and that he would email me a standard new client agreement could I please sign and return. I was at work that day and I quickly e signed and sent back to him via email. No mention of any charges fees for this call (it was literally the first time I'd ever spoken to him). Charge on invoice for this date: $467.11 total. The agreement was pro-forma it couldn't have taken 10 mins to fill with Max's details and email me.

14. On the 30/09/21 Luke and a therapy assistant named James, came to my home to meet with myself and Max. The meeting lasted 2 hours. During the meeting time itself, Luke completed therapy plan document and emailed it to me whilst we were still in the meeting (so I know it did not take additional time to complete). Charge on the invoice for this date $663.65. During this meeting it was explained to us that

James (the therapy assistant) would be meeting with Max to help implement the plan. This would benefit us because any work done by James will be charged at a therapy assistant rate which will help his budget stretch further. This sounded reasonable so we agreed. Later that day James emailed me a basic chore chart.

15. I then made an appointment with James for 4/10/21 and 05/10/21. The appointment on the 4th was cancelled due to it being a public holiday. He came on the 5th & 6th October. He completed one of the tasks with Max during this appointment. This is the computer parts list. He emailed it to me on completion of their time that day to print out and laminate. I believe these appointments were around 1 hour but could potentially have been 2. As James is only a therapy assistant we anticipated it being charged at the therapy assistant rates (as we were told). They have charged $484.98 for the 4/10 and no meeting happened, $387.96 for a meeting with the therapy assistant on the 5th, $469.66 on the 7/10 and no meeting actually happened.

16. The invoice was sent to me dated the 18th of October, 2021 but I did not receive it until December, 2021. I spoke to my plan manager on the 7th of December, 2021. I did not believe that this invoice was right. I questioned this with Luke Hazelwood who was the therapist and he said no it was not right and told me not to pay it.

Exhibit : I now produce the invoice dated 18th October , 2021 . Annexure RT 02

17. I received an invoice from the plan manager on 25th March, 2021. These were for the period 2/2/2021 – 14/3/2021. I was being charged for Behaviour therapies but I did not receive any services from them at all. This was for $224.63

Exhibit : I now produce the invoice dated 25th March, 2021 . Annexure RT 03

18. I provided FFG with a copy of Max's plan as Luke said that he needed this to complete the service agreement.

19. I signed the service agreement and this was dated the 24Do you have a service agreement

Signature

Witness

Exhibit : I now produce the service agreement dated 24th September 2021 . Annexure RT 04

20. I did not agree with the invoices and I rang FFG and spoke to Blake SADLER who I believe is the account manager. He confirmed that they were right. I disagreed as I knew what services were provided and what wasn't.

21. FFG were refusing to review the invoices so I told him I would complain to the NDIS and the commission and he told me to go for it.

22. I made a complaint to the NDIS in relation to the overcharging for therapies. I was referred to the complaints department and was told someone would get back to me. I was later contacted and told to put everything in an email.

23. The same day after speaking to NDIS a female who identified herself as the owner of the group phoned me. She said her name was Vida REID. She told me that I was wrong and the invoices were correct. She said that she understood, I was upset and that she had a child with a disability and was not using my child as a ATM machine. We continued to discuss the invoices.

24. Vida told me to pay the invoices and then she would get Max's plan reviewed and increase his budget, but this can not happen until I paid the invoices. She told me that I needed to prove to the NDIS that I needed the money and to do this we had to spend the money on the invoices.

25. I agreed to meet with her to discuss the invoices to give her the opportunity to explain the charges. I did agree, but after the phone call my anxiety increased and I could not face her. I felt bullied and steam rolled by her on the phone and could only imagine how bad she would be in person.

26. Vida told me that she had rolled out the NDIS in Western Australia and that she was so important, nothing could be done to her.

27. In relation to invoices I had numerous phone calls from Blake, he would call me every day or every two days. I was constantly ignoring his calls as I had made a complaint to the commission in relation to his overcharging.

28. I have anxiety and since having being harassed by Blake and Vida I am now no longer confident in answering my phone. I felt threatened and intimidated by Vida and Blake and their harassment of me.

29. FFG overcharged my child for services not provided and I feel they have stolen from me and my child.

This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

Signature RTeague
Rhiannon TEAGUE

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about 1210 on 11 October 2022 at Maylands in Western Australia.

Signature

Fiona Lane
Senior Investigator

Perth, Western Australia